CLOUD NATIVE
COMPUTING FOUNDATION

Welcome to the CNCF Governing Board

Updated December 2025

Overview of CNCF Governance

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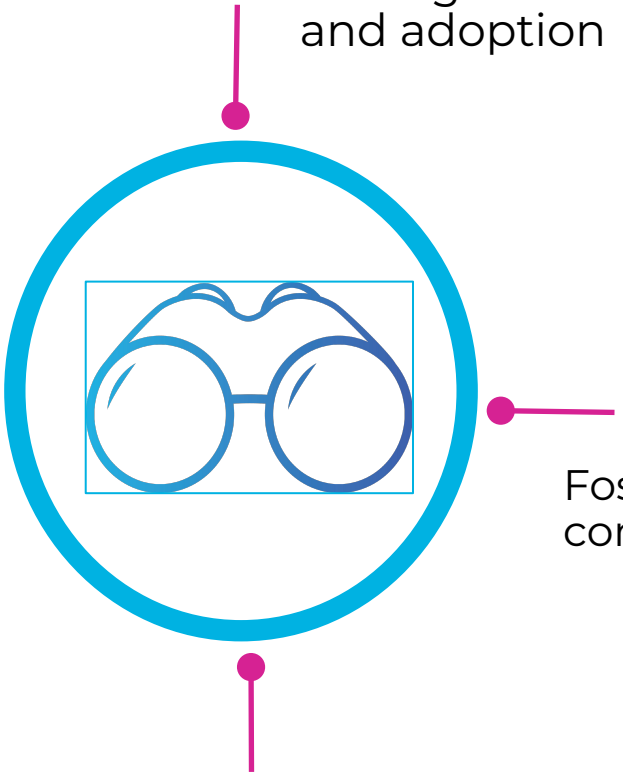
THE ROLE OF THE FOUNDATION



Drive global awareness and adoption

Foster a vibrant community

Ensure coherence in strategy and action

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We’re a nonprofit, but not separately incorporated

- CNCF is part of the the Linux Foundation and is not a separate legal entity
- Therefore, the CNCF Governing Board is not a corporate board of directors, and is not subject to corporate law statutes (e.g., those that govern fiduciary duties and how corporate boards of directors must operate)
- The powers and duties of the Governing Board are set forth in the CNCF Charter

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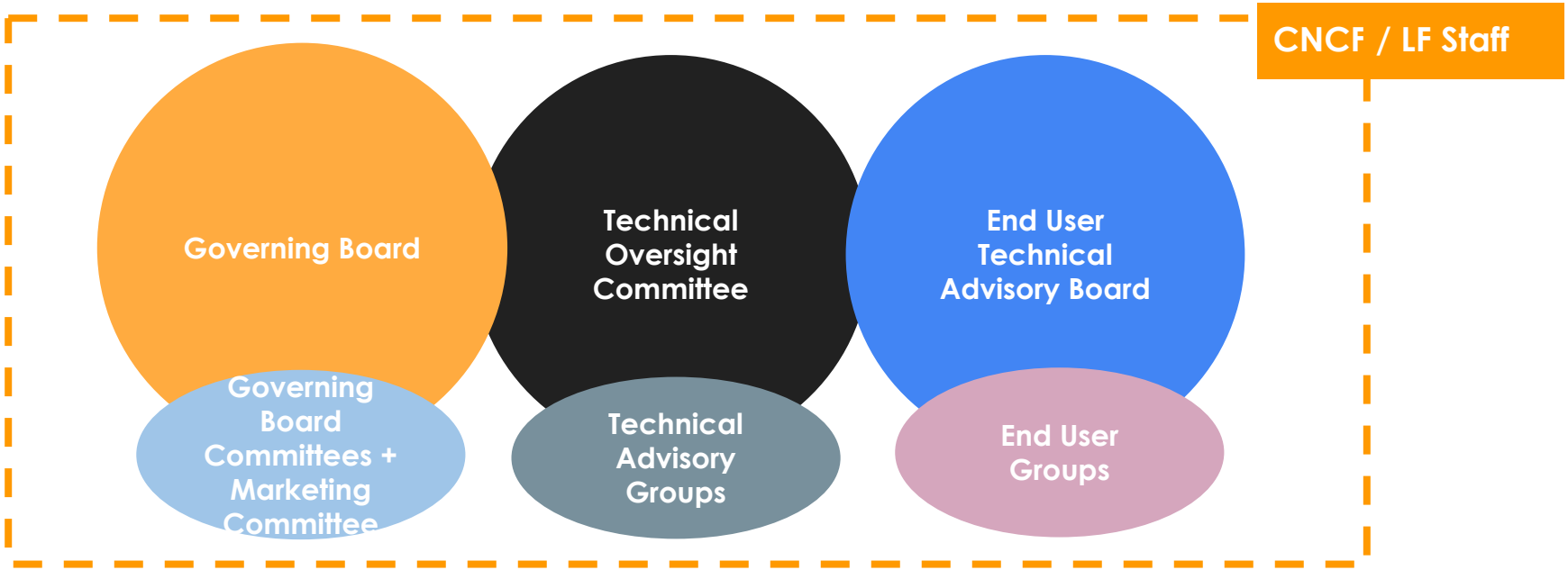
CNCF Governance Structure



A triumvirate of the technical community + end users + governing board

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Key Governing Bodies and Committees

- **Business & Marketing Leadership**
  - CNCF Governing Board (GB)
    - GB Budget Committee
    - Legal Committee

- **Technical Leadership**
  - Technical Oversight Committee (TOC)
    - You can review the TOC activity and upcoming schedule, join the mailing list or view the election schedule
  - Technical Advisory Groups

- **End User Community**
  - End User Technical Advisory Board
  - End User Groups

- **CNCF Code of Conduct Committee**

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Governing Board Responsibilities

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Governing Board Responsibilities

The Governing Board's responsibilities include:

- Approving the CNCF budget, directing the use of funds to advance the mission of the CNCF;
- Defining and enforcing policy regarding intellectual property (copyright patent, or trademark) of the foundation;
- Directing marketing and evangelism efforts;
- Providing financial governance overall;
- Voting on other decisions that come before the Governing Board.

Additional responsibilities are described in Section 5 of the CNCF Charter.

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What the Governing Board is NOT responsible for

- The GB does **not** make technical decisions for CNCF other than working with the **TOC** to set the overall scope for the CNCF.

- The GB is **not** responsible for overseeing day-to-day operations of CNCF. This is the responsibility of the foundation staff.

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Governing Board Operations

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Governing Board Composition

- Meet the current **Governing Board Members**
- The Governing Board voting members consist of Member Representatives and Technical Community Representatives:
  - Member Representatives consist of:
    a. one representative appointed from each Platinum member; and
    b. the Gold and Silver member elected representatives (if any)
  - Technical Community Representatives consist of:
    a. the TOC Chair, and
    b. two Committers elected from the CNCF Projects, one of whom represents the Kubernetes project and the other of whom represents other CNCF projects, per the Maintainers Election Policy.
- See Section 5(c) CNCF Charter for more information about composition.

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Governing Board Committees

- Legal Committee
  - The CNCF Legal Committee makes recommendations to the Governing Board regarding license exception requests from CNCF projects and other questions submitted to the Legal Committee by the Governing Board.
  - The Legal Committee does not represent CNCF and does not have an attorney-client relationship with CNCF.
  - **If you would like appoint a Legal Committee representative for your organization, please let us know.**
- Budget Committee
  - The Budget Committee collaborates with the CNCF staff to develop and review the CNCF budget.

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Meeting Cadence

- The Governing Board has **3 regular meetings** per year
  - At these meetings, voting may take place
  - The TOC and End User TAB are usually invited to part of each regular Governing Board meeting to facilitate collaboration

- Additionally, the Governing Board has **2 in person strategy sessions** per year (at KubeCon + CloudNativeCons in North America and Europe)
  - Strategy sessions are for discussion and brainstorming. They are not official board meetings, and thus no voting takes place at Strategy Sessions.
  - TOC and End User TAB members are also invited to Strategy Sessions

- In rare and exceptional circumstances (e.g., in an emergency situation), an additional ad hoc **special meeting** of the GB may be convened.
  - *To request a special meeting, please email your request the Executive Director and Governing Board Chair, and they will decide whether a special meeting is necessary or the proposed agenda item can be discussed by email or at the next regular meeting.*

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How to submit a proposal or suggest an agenda item

- If you would like to submit a proposal for the GB to consider or suggest an agenda topic for an upcoming meeting, please submit your proposal to the CNCF Executive Director (or VP of Strategic Programs + Legal) and the Governing Board Chair.
    - CNCF leadership will work with you to determine: (a) whether the proposal needs input or approval from other bodies and stakeholders within the community (e.g., the TOC, TAB) before it is ready for evaluation by the GB; (b) inform you of whether there are already ongoing initiatives within CNCF that address the concerns you have raised; and (c) package up the relevant information about the proposal for sharing with the GB.
- For a regular GB meeting, please submit your proposed agenda item <u>at least 10 days prior to the meeting</u>.
- For a Strategy Session, please submit your proposed agenda item <u>at least 30 days prior to the meeting.</u>

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Submitting a proposal or suggesting an agenda topic (continued)

- Please be patient. Our board meeting agendas are often very full. If we cannot accommodate your request in the upcoming meeting we may:
  - Wait until the following meeting to discuss the topic
  - Call a special meeting to discuss your topic, or
  - Refer the topic to the appropriate committee or task force of the Governing Board.
- We may ask you to provide slides 5 days before the meeting, and slides are subject to change (with your approval) to fit the broader meeting slide deck.

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Alternates Policy

- Platinum, Gold, and Silver member companies with representatives on the Governing Board may appoint alternates.
- Alternates may attend all Governing Board meetings.
  - If the primary representative is present, the alternate may participate in listen-only mode and may not vote or speak.
  - Only if the primary representative is unable to attend the meeting, the alternate may speak and vote in lieu of the primary representative.
- At Governing Board + TOC strategy sessions (at which no voting occurs), both primary and alternate representatives may speak (the alternate does not need to participate in listen-only mode)

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Governing Board Minutes

In August 2020, the CNCF Governing Board decided that going forward, meeting minutes would be published for transparency.

- **Private** unredacted version of minutes along with meeting slide decks are stored in CNCF's Google Drive.

- **Public** versions of minutes stored here: CNCF Governing Board Repo
  - Public versions omit executive sessions, do not attribute comments to individual board members, and also redact confidential and sensitive information

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Minutes Approval Process

1. **Draft Circulate** 1–2 weeks after each GB meeting, CNCF staff will email a draft of the minutes to GB members requesting feedback by a specified date.
2. **Review Period:** GB members will have at least 3 weeks to review and propose changes (the “Review Period”).
3. **Approval Without Changes:** If no changes are suggested during the initial Review Period, the minutes will be automatically approved.
4. **If Changes are Proposed:** If changes are proposed, the Review Period will extended by 1 week.
    - **If there are no sustained objections** to the changes, the minutes will be revised to include those changes and deemed approved.
    - **If there are sustained objections** to any proposed changes, the disagreement will be resolved using the GB’s standard decision-making procedures.

The complete minutes approval process is documented here.

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Mailing Lists and Slack Channel

Relevant Mailing Lists:

- GB: cncf-gb@lists.cncf.io
- TOC: cncf-toc@lists.cncf.io
- Budget Committee: cncf-budget-committee@lists.cncf.io
- Legal Committee: cncf-legal-committee@lists.cncf.io
- Code of Conduct Committee: conduct@cncf.io

Governing Board Slack Channel

- You can join CNCF slack here.
- To be added to the Governing Board Slack channel, please message Taylor Waggoner, Program Manager, via Slack or email

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Primary Contacts for GB Matters

The following are your primary contacts for matters related to the CNCF Governing Board:

Role	Name	Email
Governing Board Chairperson	Christoph Blecker	cblecker@gmail.com
CNCF Executive Director	Jonathan Bryce	jbryce@linuxfoundation.org
CNCF VP of Strategic Program & Legal	Joanna Lee	jlee@linuxfoundation.org
CNCF Program Manager	Taylor Waggoner	twaggoner@linuxfoundation.org

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Policies and Other Resources

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Governing Board Buddy Program

Program Overview: This Governing Board Buddy Program supports new GB members onboarding and integration. We'll pair new board members "Mentee" Buddies with experienced "Mentor" Buddies for guidance and support with integration. ***Participation is optional and voluntary.***

Suggested Engagement:

✅ **Onboarding** – We suggest Buddies meet with each other 1:1 shortly after being paired
✅ **Introductions** – Mentors will introduce their Mentee-Buddy to others at in person GB events and otherwise help them feel welcome and included
✅ **Guidance** – Mentors will be available to answer questions and provide guidance about CNCF board culture, decision-making, and norms

Mentor Buddies: Open to individuals who have been on the GB > 1 year and have strong knowledge of the CNCF ecosystem.

Please let Taylor Waggoner <twaggoner@linuxfoundation.org> know if you're willing to serve as a Mentor-Buddy.

Mentee Buddies: We will automatically include GB members who have been on the GB **less than 1 year**, unless they opt out of participating.

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Policies to be aware of

LF / CNCF Policies:

- CNCF Charter
- Linux Foundation Antitrust Policy
- CNCF Code of Conduct
- Political Neutrality Policy
- CNCF's intellectual property and licensing policies are contained in the following documents:
  - Section 11 of the CNCF Charter
  - CNCF Allowlist License Policy

Governing Board Policies:

- Licensing Exception Streamlined Approval Policy
- GB Meeting Minutes Approval Process

GB policies are also available in this Google Drive folder.

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Who’s Who in CNCF

- CNCF Members
- Staff: CNCF Staff, Linux Foundation Leadership
- Governing Board members
- Technical Oversight Committee Members
- CNCF Project Maintainers
- CNCF Ambassadors

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Learn More About CNCF

- CNCF Overview
- CNCF Annual Reports:
  - 2025
  - 2024
  - 2023
  - 2022
- CNCF Landscape
- Introduction to our End User Community

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Thank you